supply chains, agri-processing and logistics. So far, officials say, 987 investment proposals with projected investments of around Rs 47,000 crore have been received. The proposals came after the UPEIDA invited Expressions of Interest from investors and developers for industrial and logistics clusters along the corridor in June 2025.

In Meerut, about 529 acres have been identified along a 10-km stretch, while Hapur has around 304 acres planned across 54 km. Bulandshahr, with roughly 2,798 acres, is the largest cluster on the route, followed by nodes in Amroha (348 acres), Sambhal (591 acres), Budaun (269 acres), Shahjahanpur (252 acres), Hardoi (335 acres), Unnao (333 acres), Raebareli (232 acres), Pratapgarh (263 acres) and Prayagraj (251 acres). Together, these form a chain of proposed industrial zones that run almost the entire length of the expressway. According to Kumar, the corridor is expected to gradually shift investment beyond the National Capital Region (NCR). "At present, most industries are concentrated around NCR," he says. "But with the industrial corridor, industries will increasingly come up in districts along the expressway because they can access cheaper land and labour while still being connected to the NCR and other markets within a few hours."



"INDUSTRIES WILL INCREASINGLY COME UP ALONG THE EXPRESSWAY AS THEY CAN ACCESS CHEAPER LAND AND LABOUR WHILE STILL BEING CONNECTED TO THE NCR AND OTHER MARKETS WITHIN A FEW HOURS"

DEEPAK KUMAR
CEO, UPEIDA

Agriculture is another key part of the plan. Better roads will allow perishable produce to reach markets faster, reducing spoilage and potentially improving prices. Stronger mandi linkages and smoother transport are also expected to benefit farmers. The expressway is expected to boost religious and cultural tourism as well, with easier access to sites such as Prayagraj likely to increase tourist traffic and support local economies. "Goods will move faster, logistics costs will come down, and tourism will also benefit significantly," Kumar says.

THE PATH AHEAD

For all its scale and ambition, the Ganga Expressway also raises a set of immediate, practical questions. Cost is one of them. A two-wheeler travelling the full stretch from Meerut to Prayagraj will pay around Rs 905 in toll. For a car, the cost rises to roughly Rs 1,800, while buses and trucks could pay as much as Rs 5,720. For frequent users, especially transport operators, it feeds directly into logistics costs, which the expressway is otherwise meant to reduce.

Kumar says the pricing follows a fixed mathematical formula linked to project economics and projected traffic flow. "These costs are determined through studies conducted before the project begins. Construction costs, traffic projections and operational calculations are all taken into account." Though the state government kept the road toll-free for an initial 15-day period to encourage usage, a fully automated, sensor-based tolling system is in place across the corridor to ensure smoother movement without long queues at toll plazas.

Meanwhile, the Opposition Samajwadi Party is taking the government to task over the quality of facilities along the corridor, particularly public amenities. "It has hardly been a few days since the inauguration, and many of the toilets and facilities are already damaged," says party spokesperson Manoj Singh Kaka. He also alleges that certain companies received an undue advantage in the awarding of contracts. "When the selection process itself is not fair and transparent, questions about quality will naturally arise," he claims.

Kumar rejects these allegations, saying the tendering system was fully transparent and conducted online. Developed under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model, the expressway project was divided into four large packages awarded to companies such as IRB Infrastructure and the Adani

CORRIDOR OF OPPORTUNITY

The proposed economic corridor along the Ganga Expressway aims to turn districts on the stretch into hubs for manufacturing, logistics, warehousing, agri-processing and e-commerce supply chains

MEERUT

Being positioned as a key entry point due to its link to the Delhi-Meerut Expressway and proximity to the national capital. Expected to emerge as a hub for data centres, warehousing, sports goods, logistics and e-commerce

₹47,000 cr.
PROJECTED INVESTMENT

987
INVESTMENT PROPOSALS RECEIVED

6,507 acres
EARMARKED FOR VARIOUS PROJECTS

12
INDUSTRIAL NODES IDENTIFIED